

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** B

Options: A) within the past 6,000 years; B) within the past 12,000 years; C) within the past 18,000 years; D) within the past 28,000 years

Note: The correct answer is within the past 12,000 years because this timeframe coincides with the Neolithic Revolution, when humans transitioned from nomadic hunter-gatherer lifestyles to settled agricultural practices, leading to the domestication of plants and animals.

2. **Answer:** C

Options: A) 65,000 to no later than 48,000 years ago; B) 45,000 to no later than 38,000 years ago; C) 35,000 to no later than 18,000 years ago; D) 15,000 to no later than 10,000 years ago

Note: The correct answer is supported by archaeological and genetic studies that trace the domestication of dogs from wolves to a timeline between 35,000 and 18,000 years ago, indicating a significant period for the evolution of dogs as a distinct species.

3. **Answer:** A

Options: A) chiefdom; B) archaic state; C) egalitarian society; D) democratic state

Note: A chiefdom is a social organization that includes a centralized leadership and a more complex social structure than a tribe, but it lacks the formal governmental institutions and bureaucratic systems characteristic of a state.

4. **Answer:** D

Options: A) The structure of the innominate, including the ilium and ischium; B) The position of the foramen magnum; C) The absence of a divergent big toe; D) All the above

Note: The correct answer "All the above" is appropriate because paleoanthropologists use multiple lines of evidence, such as skeletal structure, fossil footprints, and comparative anatomy with other species, to determine if a species exhibits bipedalism.

5. **Answer:** D

Options: A) a systematic classification based on similarities and differences.; B) a dating technique based on the decay of a radioactive isotope of bone.; C) a study of the spatial relationships among artifacts, ecofacts, and features.; D) the study of how materials ended up in a particular place.

Note: Taphonomy focuses on the processes that affect organic remains from the time of death to their discovery, including how and why materials are deposited in specific locations, making the study of how materials ended up in a particular place the correct answer.

True / False

6. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The discovery of caribou bones indicates their presence in North America rather than suggesting they were imported from Canada, as caribou are native to that region.

7. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: An archaeological artifact refers to objects made or used by humans, such as tools or pottery, rather than the locations where people lived and worked.

8. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Crop irrigation systems were not developed until the Neolithic period when societies transitioned to settled agriculture, as the Mesolithic era was characterized by a hunter-gatherer lifestyle without the need for such advanced agricultural techniques.

9. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Palynology is indeed the study of pollen, and it allows scientists to analyze fossilized pollen grains to understand past plant communities and climate conditions, making the statement true.

10. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: A forensic anthropologist applies their expertise in human skeletal analysis to assist law enforcement in solving crimes and identifying victims based on skeletal remains.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** Stratigraphy is significant in understanding Earth's history because it involves the study of rock layers, or strata, which reveal information about the planet's past environments and events. By examining these layers, scientists can identify the age of rocks and fossils, helping to piece together a timeline of geological and biological changes over millions of years. This study allows us to understand how ancient climates, natural disasters, and life forms evolved, contributing to our knowledge of the Earth's development. Additionally, stratigraphy helps us uncover patterns of extinction and survival, giving insight into the resilience of life through changing conditions. Overall, stratigraphy is a vital tool in reconstructing the narrative of Earth's history.
- Note:* correct because it emphasizes that stratigraphy provides crucial insights into the age and development of Earth's layers, which in turn helps scientists reconstruct historical geological events and biological evolution over time.

12. **Answer:** The Solutrean and Magdalenian traditions are two significant cultural phases in prehistoric Europe, each characterized by distinct tool-making techniques and materials. The Solutrean, which dates back to approximately 22,000 to 17,000 years ago, is known for its sophisticated stone tools, particularly the distinctive bifacial points crafted from flint, which were often finely shaped and highly polished. In contrast, the Magdalenian tradition, which followed, around 17,000 to 12,000 years ago, is recognized for its diverse array of tools, including bone and antler implements, as well as the use of blades made from flint. The significance of these traditions lies in their demonstration of advanced cognitive abilities and adaptability of prehistoric peoples, reflecting their responses to changing environments and resource availability. Together, they illustrate the evolution of human ingenuity in tool-making during the Upper Paleolithic period. *Note:* correct because it accurately identifies and contrasts the Solutrean and Magdalenian traditions by detailing their respective timeframes, distinct tool-making techniques, and the materials used, highlighting their significance in prehistoric cultural development.